

AMEC (688012.SS): New tools launched in etching and deposition; Memory and Advanced nodes tools to drive growth ahead; Buy

We are positive on AMEC's growth outlook, driven by (1) solid semiconductor equipment demand from memory and advanced logic customers in China, (2) rising local equipment penetration, and (3) the company's continued product expansion from etching into deposition and adjacent equipment categories. We expect AMEC's revenues to grow by 28% / 31% QoQ to Rmb4,819mn / Rmb6,306mn in 3Q26E / 4Q26E. As highlighted in our [CHIPS IV](#) report, we estimate China WFE spending to grow by 13% / 20% / 15% YoY in 2026E-28E to US\$61bn by 2028E, benefiting leading semiconductor equipment suppliers including AMEC. At CSEAC 2026 ([link](#)), AMEC launched six new tools covering extreme high-aspect-ratio etching, dielectric-film deposition, molybdenum ALD, integrated metal-film deposition and SiC epitaxy. We believe the expanded portfolio broadens AMEC's process coverage and could increase its equipment content per customer and production line. Maintain Buy.

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Exhibit 1: AMEC Primo XD-RIE™



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Higher aspect-ratio etch for advanced memory: AMEC launched its Primo XD-RIE extreme high-aspect-ratio etcher for increasingly complex structures in 3D NAND and DRAM. As memory products migrate toward higher layer counts, manufacturers need to etch deeper and narrower structures while maintaining vertical profiles, wafer-level uniformity and stable critical dimensions, increasing both process complexity and etching intensity. **Primo XD-RIE supports 70:1-90:1 extreme high-aspect-ratio etching** and incorporates a high-power multi-level pulsed RF system, adjustable DC bias, low-temperature etching and enhanced plasma-distribution and edge control. We believe the product extends AMEC's

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existing strength in memory etching into more demanding process generations, while higher layer counts and longer etching times could increase customers' equipment requirements.

Broader deposition process coverage: AMEC launched five deposition tools covering advanced memory, logic and power semiconductor applications. Its QuaStar ON/GE PECVD systems target dielectric-film deposition for 3D NAND and advanced logic and can process up to 16 / 12 wafers per system, respectively, expanding AMEC's coverage from deep-structure etching to the preceding multilayer deposition processes. The company also introduced Unicore AM, a 12-inch molybdenum ALD tool for word-line fill in high-stack memory, addressing the need for more conformal metal deposition as device structures become deeper and narrower. Meanwhile, Uniflash integrates in-situ pre-cleaning, titanium and titanium-nitride deposition within one platform, while PDS8 extends the company's portfolio into 8-inch SiC epitaxy. We believe these products broaden AMEC's addressable market and could increase its equipment content per customer and production line.

Earnings revision: We revise up our revenue estimates by 4.8% / 7.8% / 10.3% in 2026E-28E, mainly on higher shipment volumes, from accelerating shipment growth. We revise down our GM estimates by 1.6ppts / 1.3ppts / 0.8ppt, reflecting lower margin of new products' initial ramp up, and competition. Together with higher operating expenses related to new products expansion and sales investments, our 2026E-28E NI estimates are revised by -3.1% / -3.1% / +2.8%.

Exhibit 2: Earnings revision

Rmb m	2026E			2027E			2028E		
	Old	New	Diff (%)	Old	New	Diff (%)	Old	New	Diff (%)
Revenue	17,003	17,817	4.8%	23,100	24,899	7.8%	29,723	32,784	10.3%
Gross profit	7,103	7,157	0.8%	10,132	10,607	4.7%	13,328	14,435	8.3%
Op. income	3,243	3,060	-5.7%	6,256	6,038	-3.5%	9,065	9,344	3.1%
Net income	5,251	5,088	-3.1%	6,062	5,872	-3.1%	8,342	8,579	2.8%
Margins									
GM	41.8%	40.2%	-1.6ppts	43.9%	42.6%	-1.3ppts	44.8%	44.0%	-0.8ppts
OPM	19.1%	17.2%	-1.9ppts	27.1%	24.2%	-2.8ppts	30.5%	28.5%	-2ppts
NM	30.9%	28.6%	-2.3ppts	26.2%	23.6%	-2.7ppts	28.1%	26.2%	-1.9ppts

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: AMEC P&L Summary

Rmb mn	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	2,173	2,787	3,102	4,322	2,915	3,776	4,819	6,306	4,740	6,264	9,065	12,385	17,817	24,899	32,784
Gross profit	903	1,074	1,175	1,698	1,163	1,496	1,983	2,515	2,168	2,870	3,722	4,850	7,157	10,607	14,435
Operating expense	668	876	931	1,044	773	1,096	1,001	1,228	1,265	1,664	2,409	3,520	4,098	4,570	5,091
Operating income	235	198	244	654	390	400	983	1,286	903	1,206	1,313	1,330	3,060	6,038	9,344
Pre tax profit	294	423	509	963	977	1,902	1,117	1,425	1,259	2,010	1,709	2,190	5,421	6,749	10,093
Net income	313	393	505	900	930	1,895	994	1,269	1,170	1,786	1,616	2,111	5,088	5,872	8,579
EPS (Rmb)	0.34	0.42	0.54	0.96	1.00	1.98	1.04	1.32	1.90	2.89	2.61	2.26	5.34	6.13	8.96
Margins / ratio															
Gross margin	41.5%	38.5%	37.9%	39.3%	39.9%	39.6%	41.2%	39.9%	45.7%	45.8%	41.1%	39.2%	40.2%	42.6%	44.0%
Opex ratio	30.7%	31.4%	30.0%	24.2%	26.5%	29.0%	20.8%	19.5%	26.7%	26.6%	26.6%	28.4%	23.0%	18.4%	15.5%
Operating margin	10.8%	7.1%	7.9%	15.1%	13.4%	10.6%	20.4%	20.4%	19.0%	19.3%	14.5%	10.7%	17.2%	24.2%	28.5%
Net margin	14.4%	14.1%	16.3%	20.8%	31.9%	50.2%	20.6%	20.1%	24.7%	28.5%	17.8%	17.0%	28.6%	23.6%	26.2%
QoQ															
Revenue	-39%	28%	11%	39%	-33%	30%	28%	31%							
Gross profit	-35%	19%	9%	44%	-32%	29%	33%	27%							
Operating income	-57%	-15%	23%	168%	-40%	3%	146%	31%							
Pre tax profit	-61%	44%	20%	89%	1%	95%	-41%	28%							
Net income	-55%	25%	29%	78%	3%	104%	-48%	28%							
Revenue	35%	51%	51%	21%	34%	35%	55%	46%	52%	32%	45%	37%	44%	40%	32%
Gross profit	25%	53%	31%	22%	29%	39%	69%	48%	61%	32%	30%	30%	48%	48%	36%
Operating income	-20%	24%	-21%	19%	66%	102%	303%	97%	109%	34%	9%	1%	130%	97%	55%
Pre tax profit	15%	54%	23%	26%	232%	349%	119%	48%	11%	60%	-15%	28%	148%	25%	50%
Net income	26%	47%	28%	28%	197%	382%	97%	41%	16%	53%	-10%	31%	141%	15%	46%
EPS	26%	45%	26%	27%	193%	370%	92%	37%	8%	52%	-10%	-13%	136%	15%	46%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation: Our 12-month target price is Rmb582 (vs. previously at Rmb577), still based on a discounted P/E methodology. Our target multiple continues to be based on (1) avg. ratio of global peers' P/E vs. NI YoY and OPM correlation, and (2) AMEC's 2031E NI YoY and OPM. Our new target P/E multiple is thus at 54x 2030E P/E (vs. 56x previously). We apply the 54x target P/E and discount it back to 2027E with a COE of 11% (unchanged). Maintain Buy.

Exhibit 4: AMEC discounted P/E

Rmb mn	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E
Revenue	4,740	6,264	9,065	12,385	17,817	24,899	32,784	42,291	54,133	69,290
Etcher	3,147	4,703	7,276	9,832	13,604	19,240	25,025	32,282	41,321	52,891
MOCVD	700	462	379	717	928	1,073	1,401	1,807	2,313	2,960
Parts	835	971	1,121	1,171	1,420	1,851	2,657	3,428	4,388	5,616
Maintenance	33	54	79	80	101	132	172	222	284	364
Others	25	73	54	79	113	204	449	579	742	949
Rev YoY %	52%	32%	45%	37%	44%	40%	32%	29%	28%	28%
Gross margin	45.7%	45.8%	41.1%	39.2%	40.2%	42.6%	44.0%	44.1%	44.1%	44.1%
Gross profit	2,168	2,870	3,722	4,850	7,157	10,607	14,435	18,643	23,863	30,544
Opex	1,265	1,664	2,409	3,520	4,098	4,570	5,091	6,356	7,865	9,513
Opex ratio	27%	27%	27%	28%	23%	18%	16%	15%	15%	14%
OP income	903	1,206	1,313	1,330	3,060	6,038	9,344	12,287	15,998	21,031
OPM	19%	19%	14%	11%	17%	24%	29%	29%	30%	30%
Pre-tax profit	1,259	2,010	1,709	2,190	5,421	6,749	10,093	13,036	16,747	21,780
Net profit	1,170	1,786	1,616	2,111	5,088	5,872	8,579	11,080	14,235	18,513
YoY	16%	53%	-10%	31%	141%	15%	46%	29%	28%	30%
EPS	1.90	2.89	2.61	2.26	5.34	6.13	8.96	11.57	14.86	19.33
2030 Target P/E										54.0x
12M target price (Rmb)						582				
TP implied P/E						95	65	50		

COE assumption	
Beta	1.20
Risk free	3.5%
Market risk premium	6.5%
COE	11%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: The target multiple is derived from the correlation between peers P/E and the sum of forward year earnings and OPM

	2030E P/E	2031E OPM	2031E NI YoY	Ratio
AMEC	54	30%	30%	0.9
	2027E P/E	2028E OPM	2028E NI YoY	Ratio
Accotest	53	46%	27%	0.7
Kematek	71	34%	49%	0.9
Vanchip	34	11%	21%	1.1
ASMPT	29	19%	15%	0.9
Piotech	69	25%	55%	0.9
Avg.				0.9

Source: Refinitiv Eikon, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: AMEC 12M forward P/E



Source: Eikon Datastream

Price Target Risks and Methodology - AMEC

Valuation: We are Buy-rated on AMEC with a 12-month target price of Rmb582, which is based on 54x 2030E discounted P/E (discounted back to 2027E). Our target P/E is derived from correlation between peers P/E to the sum of NI YoY and OPM.

Key downside risks: (1) Current trade restrictions do not specifically target matured node fabs, but if restrictions were to expand to matured nodes, it would further reduce demand for AMEC's products. (2) AMEC supplies etchers that can be used for 5nm production lines overseas (i.e., advanced nodes); if its ability to supply such products is hindered, it could lead to further downside risks. (3) Weaker-than-expected capex of major foundries in China.

688012.SS	12m Price Target: Rmb582.00	Price: Rmb318.55	Upside: 82.7%
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Buy		GS Forecast			
Market cap: Rmb293.8bn / \$43.8bn Enterprise value: Rmb286.6bn / \$42.7bn 3m ADTV: Rmb8.7bn / \$1.3bn China Greater China Technology M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
		12,384.6	17,816.6	24,899.2	32,784.1
		Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	12,384.6	17,003.3	23,100.4
		EBITDA (Rmb mn)	2,248.2	3,994.5	7,258.9
		EPS (Rmb) New	2.26	5.34	6.13
		EPS (Rmb) Old	2.26	5.52	6.33
		P/E (X)	64.1	59.6	52.0
		P/B (X)	5.9	10.8	9.1
		Dividend yield (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2
		CROCI (%)	17.4	29.0	26.7
		3/26	6/26	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (Rmb)	1.00	1.98	1.04	1.32

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 30 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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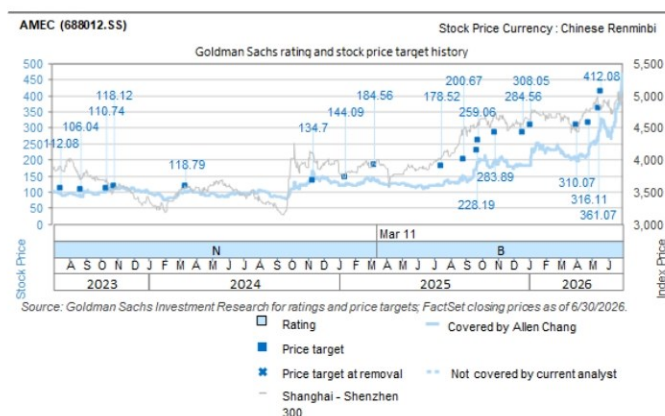
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Target price history table(s)

AMEC (688012.SS)

Date of report Target price (Rmb) Closing price (Rmb)

22-Aug-26	577.00	362.50
04-Aug-26	576.00	317.74
01-Jul-26	573.00	462.00
20-May-26	614.00	329.08
15-May-26	538.00	290.54
28-Apr-26	471.00	243.13
04-Apr-26	462.00	196.98
06-Jan-26	459.00	221.26
22-Dec-25	424.00	183.03
30-Oct-25	423.00	201.37
26-Sep-25	386.00	194.63
23-Sep-25	340.00	187.92
29-Aug-25	299.00	143.74
18-Jul-25	266.00	122.32
11-Mar-25	275.00	137.38
15-Jan-25	214.70	125.09
13-Nov-24	200.70	162.75
14-Mar-24	177.00	101.67
27-Oct-23	176.00	111.11
14-Oct-23	165.00	109.28

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